MIL-S-43589C
31 March 1983
SUPERSEDING
MIL-S-43589B
4 October 1979

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

SHAPER, POTATO MIX, FRENCH FRY

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This document covers three types of machines for shaping potato mix into french fries.

1.2 Classification. Shapers shall be of the following types and styles specified (see 6.2).

Type I	-	Hand Operated Shaper
Style 1	-	without additional forming plates
Style 2	-	with additional forming plates
Type II	-	Manual Mix, Automatic Extrusion Shaper (Minimum Production Rate: 2160 Ounces (oz.) of Formed Potato Pieces Per Hour)
Type III	-	Automatic Mix, Automatic Extrusion Shaper with Internal Rehydrating Device (Minimum Production Rate: 2160 Ounces (oz.) of Formed Potato Pieces Per Hour)

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: US Army Natick Research and Development Laboratories, Natick, MA 01760 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

FSC 7320

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2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents. Unless otherwise specified, the following documents of the issue in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

L-P-393	-	Plastic Molding Material, Polycarbonate, Injection and Extrusion
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

MILITARY

MIL-P-116	-	Preservation, Methods of
MIL-P-43744	-	Potato Mix, Dehydrated (For French-Fried Type Potatoes)

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105	-	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129	-	Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-1188	-	Commercial Packaging of Supplies and Equipment

(Copies of documents required by manufacturers in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. Unless otherwise specified, the following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

A 167	-	Stainless and Heat-Resisting Chromium-Nickel Steel Plate, Sheet, and Strip

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

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NATIONAL SANITATION FOUNDATION (NST)

Criteria C-2 - Special Equipment and/or Devices

Listing of Food Service Equipment

(Application for copies should be addressed to the National Sanitation Foundation, NSF Building, Ann Arbor, MI 48105.)

U.S. Department of Health and Human Services

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act, Food Additive Amendment for Contact with Food

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

UNDERWRITERS LABORATORIES, INC.

No. 73 - Motor-Operated Appliance

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Underwriters Laboratories, Inc., 333 Pfingsten Road, Northbrook, IL 60062.)

(Technical society and technical association documents, are generally available for references from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document shall take precedence.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Standard product. The shapers shall, as a minimum, be in accordance with the requirements of this document and shall be the manufacturer's standard commercial product with any added features needed to comply with the requirements of this document. Modifications to add features shall not incorporate different parts unless such parts are used on other current commercial models. Standard or modified commercial products furnished in accordance with this document shall be identifiable by all regular manufacturer's or commercial service organizations servicing the brand involved. Service organizations shall be capable of providing complete parts and repair services on models furnished to the Government consistent with their normal commercial practices.

3.2 Codes and standards. The shapers shall comply with the applicable requirements of NSF Criteria C-2 and UL Standard No. 73.

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3.2.1 NSF. Acceptable evidence of meeting the requirements of NSF shall be one of the following:

(a) A listing in the current edition of the NSF "Listing of Food Service Equipment" and display of the NSF seal on the finished shaper.

(b) A certification for the shapers issued by NSF under their special one-time contract evaluation/certification service.

(c) A certified test report from a recognized independent testing laboratory acceptable to the medical department of the service for which the shapers are being procured, indicating that the shapers have been tested and conform to NSF Criteria C-2.

3.2.2 UL. Acceptable evidence of meeting the applicable requirements of UL shall be the UL listing mark, or a certified test report from a recognized independent testing laboratory acceptable to the Government, indicating that the shapers have been tested and conform to UL Standard No. 73.

3.2.3 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act, Food Additive Amendment for Contact with Food. Plastic, rubber, or rubber like materials utilized in the shaper shall conform to the applicable requirements of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act, Food Additive Amendment for Contact with Food.

3.2.3.1 Certification. Prior to the approval of the first article (see 3.1), if one is submitted, or prior to the approval of the first shipment, the contractor shall furnish the contracting officer or his authorized representative a certified statement that the plastics, rubber, and rubber like materials used in the shaper he proposes to supply under this document comply with all applicable requirements of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act, Food Additive Amendment for Contact with Food.

3.3 Design. Shapers shall be designed for use with the dehydrated potato mix specified in MIL-P-43744 or manufacturers commercial mix. In general, the shapers shall consist of a ram, pressure plate, potato mix cylinders with removable slicing wires and a cut-off assembly or forming plate, and a single wire cutter. When tested as specified in 4.3.2.1 and 4.3.2.2, each shaper shall form potato pieces with uniform texture, with a minimum of 5 percent sticking and without breakage.

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3.3.1 Type I shapers. On type I, style 1 and style 2 shapers, the vertical ram shall be hand-operated by a geared handle mechanism, and the cut-off assembly shall be hand-operated, or may be automatically moved by the geared handle mechanism. The following parts shall be furnished as standard with each type I, style 1 shaper; 2 mixing cylinders (see 6.2); 2 water caps, 2 pressure plates, 1 wire whip; 1 measuring container; 1 cutter; 1 forming plate to produce standard fries. The following parts shall be finished as standard with each type I, style 2 shaper; 3 cylinders; 3 cylinder caps; 3 pressure plates; 2 cutter backs; 3 spools of cutter wire; 1 measuring container and one each of the following forming plates to produce 5/16 inch square fries, 5/16 inch crinkle cut fries, steak fries, cottage fries, and onion ring fries. The type I, style 1 and style 2 shaper overall dimensions shall be 15 inches deep, 10 inches wide and 35 inches high. When tested as specified in 4.3.1.1, the shaper cylinder for the type I, style 1 and style 2 shaper shall hold 4 pounds of reconstituted potato mix.

3.3.2 Type II shapers. On type II shapers, the ram and cut-off assemblies shall be automatically operated by electro-mechanical means each time the operating button is depressed. The following parts shall be furnished as standard with each type II shaper; 2 mixing cylinders (see 6.2); 2 water caps; 2 pressure plates; 1 wire whip; 1 measuring container; 1 cutter; 1 forming plate to produce 5/16 inch square fries; 1 steak fry forming plate and 1 cottage fry forming plate. When tested as specified in 4.3.1.1, the cylinder for the type II shaper shall hold 4 pounds of reconstituted potato mix. When tested as specified in 4.3.2.1, the type II shaper shall have a minimum production rate of 2160 ounces of formed pieces per hour.

3.3.3 Type III shapers. Type III shapers shall have both automatic mix and automatic extrusion features, and shall be furnished with a water heater tank and a dry potato mix hopper having a capacity of 13.5 pounds of potato mix to be reconstituted in batches of 22.0 ounces each when tested as specified in 4.3.1.2. When specified (see 6.2), a 14 inch or 23 inch conveyor shall be provided for moving the formed potato pieces from the shaper to the deep fat fryer. The type III shaper shall be furnished, as standard, one each of the following forming plates to produce, 1/4 inch fries, 5/16 inch crinkle fries, steak fries, cottage fries and onion ring fries. When tested as specified in 4.3.2.2, the shaper shall have a minimum production rate of 2160 ounces of formed pieces per hour.

3.4 Materials and components. Materials (see 6.3), and components shall be as specified herein. Materials not definitely specified shall be of the quality normally used by the manufacturer on his standard shapers, provided the completed items comply with all provisions of this document.

3.4.1 Stainless steel. Stainless steel shall conform to any type of material in the 300 series as specified in ASTM Standard A 167.

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3.4.2 Plastics.

3.4.2.1 Plastic molding material, polycarbonate, injection and extrusion. Plastic molding material, polycarbonate, injection and extrusion shall conform to the requirements of L-P-393.

3.4.2.2 Plastic, rubber, and rubber-like materials. Plastic, rubber, and rubber like materials shall comply with the requirements of 3.2.3 and shall be nonabsorbent, nonexuding and shall not affect or be affected by the product ingredients or by cleaning and sanitizing compound.

3.5 Construction. Stainless steel components shall conform to the requirements of 3.4.1. Plastic components shall conform to the requirements of 3.4.2.1 and 3.4.2.2. Rubber and rubber like materials shall conform to the requirements of 3.4.2.2.

3.5.1 Ram and ram housing. The ram housing shall support the ram and contain the raising and lowering mechanism which shall be fabricated in accordance with the manufacturer's standard practice. The ram shall be centrally located above the forming plate and when in the fully "up" position shall allow insertion of the cylinder between the lower end of the ram and the top surface of the forming plate. The ram shall be manually operated in type I shapers and motor operated in type II shapers. An adjustable stop shall be provided to control the length of formed potato pieces - the maximum and minimum lengths shall be in accordance with the manufacturer's standard practice. When tested as specified in 4.3.2.1, long, short and medium lengths of formed potato pieces shall be produced.

3.5.2 Forming plate. The forming plate, through which the formed potato pieces are extruded, shall be fabricated from stainless steel. The plate shall be supported by a pedestal or legs, and shall have a lug or projection on the outer edge to locate the plate in the stand. The circumference of the forming plate shall snugly fit the bottom of the cylinder.

3.5.3 Pressure plate. The type I, style 1 and type II shaper pressure plate shall be fabricated of stainless steel with replaceable "O" rings for obtaining a close fit with the cylinder wall, or may be an aluminum plate molded into plastic, with a formed lip to obtain a close fit with the cylinder wall. The aluminum plate shall have a thickness not less than 3/8 inch and a diameter not less than 1 inch less than the inside diameter of the cylinder. The type I, style 2 shaper pressure plate shall be fabricated of molded plastic. The top of the pressure plate shall be slotted and shall fit onto a matching slotted end at the lower section of the ram.

3.5.4 Cut-off assembly. Cut-off components shall be fabricated of stainless steel. The cut-off plate, or cutter wire located under the forming plate, shall completely sever all formed potato strips. The assembly shall be provided with a positive stop and return spring so cut-off does not interfere with the forming operation. Cut-off components shall be removable from the machine for cleaning and replacement.

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3.5.5 Type I, and type II cylinders. The cylinder shall be fabricated of plastic or stainless steel. The cylinder for the type I, and type II shall have a capacity of not less than 4 pounds of reconstituted potato mix. The bottom rims of type I and type II cylinders shall be shaped to fit the forming plates.

3.6 Electrical requirements.

3.6.1 Motor. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the electric motor for type II and III shapers shall be totally enclosed, continuous duty, 115 volt, 60 cycle, single phase, and fractional horsepower of adequate capacity.

3.6.2 Switch. A toggle switch shall be mounted on the motor, or some adjacent part of the shaper. The switch rating shall be not less than the rating of the motor, and shall be connected so as not to open the grounding circuit.

3.6.3 Cord. The electric cord shall be not less than 6-feet long, with 3-pole cord grip plug.

3.7 Marking. Each potato shaper shall have a corrosion-resisting steel identification plate securely attached to the body of the machine. The plate shall include the contract number, date of contract, manufacturer's name or trademark and model and serial number. Markings shall be permanent and legible.

3.8 Finish. Finish shall conform to the applicable requirements of NSF Criteria C-2.

3.9 Workmanship. The shaper shall be complete and clean. Components shall be neatly finished and all burrs or rough edges shall be removed. Welds shall be sound, smooth, and free from pits, fractures, burn-through, or fissures. Spot welds shall be free from pits and flashes. Bolt holes and rivet holes shall be accurately punched or drilled and shall have burrs removed. Washers or lock-washers shall be provided in accordance with standard commercial practice, and all bolts, nuts, and screws shall be drawn tight.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the document where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

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4.2 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.2.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this document or applicable purchase document.

4.2.2 In-process inspection. Examination shall be made of the aluminum, plastic imbedded pressure plates, when used, to determine compliance with the dimensional and material requirements of 3.5.3. Whenever nonconformance is noted, correction shall be made to the affected items and the lot in-process.

4.2.3 End item visual examination. The end item shall be examined for the defects listed in table I. The lot size shall be expressed in units of shapers. The sample unit shall be one completely fabricated shaper. The inspection level shall be II and the acceptable quality level (AQL), expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5 for major defects and 6.5 for total (major and minor combined) defects.

TABLE I. End item visual defects

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Construction and workmanship (applicable to all components)	Any component missing	X	
	Any component fractured or malformed affecting usability	X	
	Any burr or rough edge	X	
Welding	Any weld fractured, not sound, or contains fissures or burn through	X	
	Any weld not smooth or contains pits	X	
	Spot weld contains flashes	X	
Bolts, nuts, screws	Stripped or fractured	X	
	Loose or not provided with lock-washers		X

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TABLE I. End item visual defects

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Detailed construction			
Ram	Not centrally located above forming plate (check visually, measure if in doubt)	X	
	Does not allow insertion of cylinder when in up position	X	
Forming plate	Material not as specified	X	
	Locating lug or projection not as specified	X	
	Does not fit cylinder	X	
Pressure plate	Materials not as specified	X	
	Binds in cylinder or is excessively loose	X	
	"O" rings not removable for replacement (when applicable)	X	
Cut-off assembly	Not located as specified	X	
	Cut-off interferes with extrusions	X	
	Components not removable from machine	X	
Cylinders (type I and type II)	Bottom rim not shaped to fit the forming plate	X	
Identification marking	Missing, incomplete, not legible		X
	Not located as specified		X

4.2.4 End item testing. The end item shall be tested for capacity and operation as specified in 4.3.1 and 4.3.2. The lot size shall be expressed in units of shapers. The sample unit shall be one completely fabricated shaper. The inspection level shall be II and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 4.0.

4.2.5 Standards compliance. Certificate of compliance, certified test reports, approval labels or listing marks for codes and standards, as applicable, that are submitted as proof of compliance with the document requirements shall be examined and validated.

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4.2.6 Packaging inspection. An examination shall be made to determine that preservation, packing and marking comply with the section 5 requirements. Defects shall be scored in aaccordance with the list below. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully packaged with the exception that it need not be closed. Examination of closure defects listed below shall be made on shipping containers fully packaged. The lot size shall be the number of containers in the inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5.

Markings (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application
Materials	Any component missing, damaged or not as specified.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as: incomplete closure of container flap, loose strapping, improper taping, or inadequate stapling. Bulged or distorted container.

4.3 Methods of inspection.

4.3.1 Capacity.

4.3.1.1 Type I, style 1 and style 2 and type II. Rehydrate 4 pounds of the potato mix using mix specified in MIL-P-43744 (or manufacturers' standard commercial mix) in accordance with the potato mix manufacturers' instructions. The rehydration shall be accomplished in the cylinder with the pressure plate or cylinder cap, in place, as applicable. Failure of the cylinder to accommodate the entire 4 pounds of rehydrated potato mix in such a manner as to permit placing the cylinder in position on the forming plate, without removing any of the mix, shall constitute noncompliance with the capacity requirements of 3.3.1 and 3.3.2 and failure of this test.

4.3.1.2 Type III. Place a quantity of the potato mix in the hopper, and start the machine so that 6.0 ounces of the mix, and a metered amount of hot water to reconstitute the mix, flows into the cylinder (one batch). When all of the mix leaves the hopper, stop the machine. Failure of the machine to process all of the mix shall constitute noncompliance with the capacity requirements of 3.3.3 and failure of this test.

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4.3.2 Operation.

4.3.2.1 Type I, style 1 and style 2 and type II. With the loaded cylinder in place, as described in 4.3.1.1, set the adjustable stop (type I, style 1 and type II shapers) for a long, then short, and then any intermediate lengths of extrusion. Make one extrusion at each length setting and cut the extrusion off. Compare the length of three extrusions to determine compliance with the length of extrusion adjustment requirement of 3.5.1 and the form requirement of 3.3.1 and 3.3.2. Operate the shaper until the cylinder is empty. During operation, observe potato pieces for uniformity of texture, sticking, and breakage, and the production rate requirements of 3.3.2. Any noncompliance with specified requirements shall constitute failure of this test.

4.3.2.2 Type III. With the cylinder loaded with reconstituted mix, restart the machine. With ready light on, and portion control at automatic position, depress the selector switch - the machine should automatically dispense potato pieces until 22 ounces have been dispersed. During operation, observe potato pieces for uniformity of texture, sticking, and breakage, and the production rate requirements of 3.3.3. Observe machine for automatic recharging of the cylinder. Any nonconformance with specified requirements shall constitute failure of this test.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be level A or Commercial as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Disassembly. The extent of disassembly shall be determined by the manufacturer. This determination shall be based on the need for protection of parts susceptible to damage during transit or storage and for the reduction in cubage. Attaching hardware shall be replaced on one of the mating parts or placed in a cloth drawstring bag and the bag attached to one of the mating parts. Disassembly shall not be such that special skills or special tools are required to place the shaper in operation.

5.1.1.2 Cleaning. All exposed, uncoated, ferrous metal surfaces shall be cleaned process C-1 and thoroughly dried in accordance with MIL-P-116.

5.1.1.3 Application for preservative. All cleaned, uncoated ferrous metal surfaces shall be coated with type P-14 preservative of MIL-P-116.

5.1.1.4 Protection of preservative. Coated surfaces, from which preservative might be removed by contact with preservation and packing materials, shall be covered, wrapped, or bagged with greaseproof barrier material in accordance with method I of MIL-P-116.

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5.1.2 Commercial. The shapers shall be preserved in accordance with MIL-STD-1188.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or Commercial as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A packing. Each complete shaper, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to RSC-L, V2s of PPP-B-636. Interior fiberboard forms shall be used to isolate and immobilize the contents to prevent damage while in transit. The inside of each fiberboard container shall be fitted with a box liner conforming to type CF, class weather-resistant, variety DW, grade V15c of PPP-B-636. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method III, waterproofed in accordance with method V, and reinforced as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636, except that the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.2.6.

5.2.2 Level B packing. Each complete shaper, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-filling fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC-L, type CF, variety SW, or type SF, class domestic of PPP-B-636. Interior fiberboard forms shall be used to isolate and immobilize the contents to prevent damage while in transit. The inside of each shipping container shall be fitted with a box liner conforming to type CF, class domestic, variety DW, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. Closure shall be in accordance with method II as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636, except that the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.2.6.

5.2.2.1 Weather-resistant containers. When specified (see 6.2), the shipping containers shall be V3c, V3s, V4s, fabricated in accordance with PPP-B-636 and closed in accordance with method III as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636, except that the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.4.6.

5.2.3 Commercial packing. Shapers, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in accordance with MIL-STD-1188.

5.3 Marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or purchase order, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129 or MIL-STD-1188, as applicable.

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6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The potato shapers covered herein are intended for use in kitchens and galleys to shape potato mix into square strips for french fries.

6.2 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this document.
(b) Type and style of shaper required (see 1.2).
(c) When a conveyor is required (see 3.3.3).
(d) Whether 14 inch or 23 inch conveyor is required (see 3.3.3).
(e) Number of cylinders if more than two (see 3.3.1 and 3.3.2).
(f) Selection of the applicable levels of preservation and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(g) When weather-resistant grade fiberboard shipping containers are required for level B packing (see 5.2.2.1).
(h) Electrical characteristics, if other than specified (see 3.6.1).

6.2.1 Contract data requirements. Any requirements for equipment manuals for the item covered by this document should be included in DD Form 1423 Contract Data Requirements List, and cited in the contract.

6.3 Recycled material. It is encouraged that recycled material be used when practical as long as it meets the requirements of the document (see 3.4).

6.4 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of DAR 7-104.55. The first article should be a preproduction sample consisting of one complete shaper. The first article should consist of one unit. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all acquisition documents, regarding arrangements for inspection and approval of the first article.

6.5 Changes from previous issue. Asterisks are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extensiveness of the changes.

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 84

Review activities:

Army - MD
Navy - MC

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project No. 7320-0722

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NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document*(s)* or to amend contractual requirements.

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ USER
	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*:

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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